UU-T-54e

August 1, 1963

SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. UU-T-0054d (GSA-FSS)
April 12, 1963 and
Fed. Spec. UU-T-54a
November 4, 1944

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TAB, INDEX, GUMMED

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers gummed index tabs for indentifying segregations in file material, alphabetical or otherwise.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Types and classes.* Tabs shall be furnished in the following types and classes, as specified (see 3.2 and 6.2).

Type I.—Cloth.

Class 1.—Individual blank tabs, angle projection.
Class 2.—Individual blank tabs, round projection.
Class 3.—Individual printed tabs, angle projection.
Class 4.—Individual printed tabs, round projection.
Class 5.—Blank strips, 6-inch.

Type II.—Paper. Individual blank tab, round projection.

Type III.—Plastic. Transparent-plastic covered, insertable 6-inch strips.

1.2.2 *Colors and sizes.* (See 3.2 and 6.2.)

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

L-P-504—Plastic Sheet and Film, Cellulose Acetate.
UU-P-31—Paper; General Specifications and Methods of Testing.
UU-P-121—Paper, Bond and Writing, White and Colored.
CCC-T-191—Textile Test Methods.
PPP-B-585—Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591—Boxes, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601—Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-645—Boxes, Folding, Fiberboard, Heavy Duty.
PPP-T-97 — Tape; Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in

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(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-B-10377—Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.
MIL-L-10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 *Cloth.* Cloth shall have a thread count of not less than 58 in the warp and 52 in the filling direction. The cloth shall have a tearing strength of not less than 200 g. in the warp direction and not less than 150 g. in the filling direction. Except for the tab skirts, all cloth shall be well sized and filled so as to have a smooth surface suitable to permit clear writing with pencil or pen and ink, without feathering. (See 4.4.1.1.)

3.1.2 *Paper.*

3.1.2.1 *Tabs.* Paper used in tabs shall have a fiber content of 100 percent chemical wood pulp and shall weigh 130 pounds (22-1/2 inches by 28-1/2 inches, 500 sheets) and shall be 0.013 inch thick, plus or minus 5 percent for weight and thickness. It shall have a minimum tearing strength of 610 g. total of both directions. The paper shall have clean, bright surfaces which will permit clear writing with pencil or pen and ink, without feathering. (See 4.4.1.2.)

3.1.2.2 *Insert labels, blank and alphabetical.* Paper used in insert labels shall be of stock weighing not less than 110 pounds (25-1/2 inches by 30-1/2 inches, 500 sheets) and having a thickness of not less than 0.0055 inch. The labels shall be suitable for writing on with pencil or pen and ink, without feathering. (See 4.4.1.2.)

3.1.3 *Plastic.* Plastic used in the tab shall conform to the requirements for type I of L-P-504 and shall be of the nominal thickness of 0.010 inch, plus or minus 0.001 inch. The transparency of the plastic shall be such that the viewing quality of the inserted material is not affected adversely.

3.2 Construction.

3.2.1 *Gum.* The inside surfaces of the skirts of the tabs and strips shall be coated evenly and completely with a good grade of gum capable of being activated quickly with water. The gum shall not block when tested as specified in 4.4.2.1 and shall have satisfactory adhesive quality to comply with tests specified in 4.4.2.2.

3.2.2 *Type I, classes 1 and 2.* The tab shall be of cloth stock; the tab projection being sufficiently reinforced so that it will stand erect from the page. The tab shall not be marked with letters or numbers.

3.2.2.1 *Color.* The color shall be gray.

3.2.2.2 *Tab projections and lengths.* Classes 1 and 2 tabs shall be furnished with the sizes, projection, and length, as specified, and shall conform to the requirements of table I. (See 6.2.)

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TABLE I.—*Type I, classes 1 and 2, individual blank cloth tabs*

Tab projection (tolerance-plus 1/8-inch)	Tab length (tolerance-plus or minus 1/16-inch)	Skirt length (tolerance-plus 1/8-inch)
Class 1, angle projection (in inches)		
3/8	7/16	3/8
3/8	3/4	3/8
3/8	1	3/8
Class 2, round projection (in inches)		
9/16	21/32	11/32

3.2.2.3 *Sets.* Individual blank cloth tabs for class 1 shall be furnished in sets of 50 tabs each. Tabs for class 2 shall be furnished in sets of 24 tabs each.

3.2.3 *Type I, classes 3 and 4.* The tab shall be of cloth stock; the tab projection being sufficiently reinforced, so that it will stand erect from the page.

3.2.3.1 *Color.* The color of the tabs shall be gray.

3.2.3.2 *Tab marking.* Tab projections shall be permanently and legibly marked with black letters and numbers as indicated in table II, and shall be furnished as specified. (See 6.2.) The names of the months and states may be abbreviated on the tabs. The sets of 52 shall include the 50 states, plus the District of Columbia and Puerto Rico.

3.2.3.3 *Tab projections and lengths.* Classes 3 and 4 tabs shall be furnished with the sizes, projection and length as specified, and shall conform to the requirements of table II. (See 6.2.)

3.2.3.4 *Sets.* Individual printed cloth tabs shall be furnished in sets containing the quantities of tabs specified in table II.

3.2.4 *Type I, class 5.* The strips shall be designed so that index tabs of the desired length, up to 6 inches, may be cut. The strips shall be of cloth stock; the strip projection being sufficiently reinforced so that it will stand erect from the pages.

3.2.4.1 *Color.* The color of the strips shall be gray.

TABLE II.—*Type I, classes 3 and 4, individual printed cloth tabs*

Tab marking	Number of tabs per set	Tab projection (Tolerance-plus 1/8-inch)	Tab length	Skirt length (Tolerance-plus 1/8-inch)	Height of numbers and letters (tolerance-plus 1/16-inch)
Class 3.—Angle projections (in inches)					
Alphabet (a)	26	3/8	3/8 to 1/2	7/16	3/16
Alphabet (b)	26	3/8	3/8 to 1/2	7/16	3/16
Numbers (1 to 31), (a)	31	3/8	3/8 to 1/2	7/16	3/16
Numbers (1 to 31), (b)	31	3/8	3/8 to 1/2	7/16	3/16
Numbers (1 to 100), (a)	100	3/8	3/8 to 1/2	7/16	3/16
Months (a)	12	3/8	11/16 to 13/16	7/16	3/16
Months (b)	12	3/8	15/16 to 1-1/16	7/16	3/16
States (a)	52	1/2	11/16 to 13/16	7/16	3/16
States (b)	52	1/2	15/16 to 1-1/16	7/16	3/16
Class 4—Round projections (in inches)					
Alphabet (b)	26	9/16	19/32 to 23/32	11/32	3/16

NOTE: (a) Side attachment, vertical reading.

(b) Top attachment, horizontal reading.

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3.2.4.2 *Strip projections and lengths.* Strips shall be furnished with the size of the projections and length, as specified, and shall conform to the requirements of table III. (See 6.2.)

TABLE III.—*Type I, class 5, blank cloth strips, 6-inch*

Projection (tolerance-plus 1/16-inch)	Tab length (tolerance-plus or minus 1/16-inch)	Skirt length (tolerance-plus 1/8-inch)
Inch	*Inches*	*Inch*
3/8	6	3/8
1/2	6	1/2

3.2.4.3 *Sets.* Blank cloth strips, 6-inch, shall be furnished in sets of 12 strips each.

3.2.5 *Type II.* The tab shall be of paper stock, and shall be so designed that when applied to the page, it will be of double thickness and will form an adequate, reinforced tab projection. The tab shall not be marked with letters or numbers.

3.2.5.1 *Color.* The color of the tabs shall be white.

3.2.5.2 *Tab projection and lengths.* Tabs shall conform to the requirements of table IV.

TABLE IV.—*Type II, paper, individual blank tab, round projection*

Tab projection (tolerance-plus 1/8-inch)	Tab length (tolerance-plus or minus 1/16-inch)	Skirt length (tolerance-plus 1/8-inch)
Inch	*Inch*	*Inch*
1/2	19/32	5/16

3.2.5.3 *Sets.* Individual blank paper tabs shall be furnished in sets of 50 tabs each.

3.2.6 *Type III.* The strips shall be designed so that index tabs of the desired length, up to 6 inches, may be cut. The strip shall consist of a transparent-plastic projection, having a double beaded edge, permanently attached to a skirt made of white cloth stock. The skirt shall be fastened securely to the plastic projection, the entire length of the strip. The plastic projection shall be the insertable type, which will securely hold two thicknesses of the paper specified in 3.1.2.2.

3.2.6.1 *Color.* The plastic projection shall be furnished in the following colors, as specified: Clear, blue, green, orange, pink, red and yellow. (See 6.2.)

3.2.6.2 *Projections, lengths, and height of letters.* Strips shall conform to the requirements of table V for size projections (as specified), lengths, and heights of letters. (See 6.2, for sizes.)

TABLE V.—*Type III, Plastic. Transparent-plastic covered, insertable 6-inch strips*

Tab projection (tolerance-plus 1/64 inch)	Tab Length (tolerance-plus 1/16-inch)	Skirt length (tolerance-plus 1/16-inch)	Height of letters
Inch	*Inches*	*Inch*	*Inch*
1/4	6	3/8	5/32 to 3/16
3/8	6	3/8	3/16 to 5/16
1/3	6	3/8	3/16 to 5/16
1/2	6	1/2	1/4 to 5/16

3.2.6.3 *Sets.* Transparent-plastic strips, of any one size and color, shall be furnished in sets containing the following: Two 6-inch plastic strips; not less than 18 inches of blank insert labels (see 3.2.6.4); two series of alphabet labels (see 3.2.6.5).

3.2.6.4 *Blank insert labels.* Blank paper insert labels shall be white, and shall be connected together in one continuous strip to

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facilitate feeding into a typewriter. They shall be of proper size to fit in the plastic strip and shall be perforated for ease in tearing apart. The labels shall be either 2-inches long (plus or minus 1/32 inch) or 6-inch long (plus 1/32 inch); each length being measured in a left-to-right direction. The 2-inch long labels shall be scored or perforated along the center in the direction of the 2-inch dimension. The 6-inch long labels shall be scored or perforated along the center in the direction of the 6-inch dimension.

3.2.6.5 *Alphabet insert labels.* Alphabet insert labels shall be white with black printed letters. The same length requirements apply as in 3.2.6.4. Each label shall be scored or perforated along the center so that the label may be folded double and easily inserted in the plastic projection. The labels shall be printed with a double series of letters in alphabetical order so that when the label is inserted with the folded edge next to the beaded top of the plastic strip, the same letter will appear on both sides of the strip. Letters shall comply with table V, and labels shall be of proper size to fit securely into the plastic projection.

3.3 **Workmanship.** Gummed index tabs shall be made of such material and by such processes as to insure compliance with the requirements of this specification. Tabs shall be free from all defects which will affect their appearance or serviceability. Tabs of any one class, size and color shall be uniform, and edges of the tabs shall be clean cut.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 **Supplier's responsibility.** Unless otherwise specified (see 6.3), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 **Sampling.**

4.2.1 *Size of lot.* All tabs of the same type, class, size, and color presented for delivery at one time shall be considered a lot for the purpose of examination.

4.2.2 *Sampling for visual and dimensional examination.* Random sample boxes or envelopes of tabs shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. Lot acceptance or rejection shall be based on an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one tab, except all tabs within the box or envelope, containing the set, shall be examined as in 4.3.1.

4.2.3 *Sampling for tests.*

4.2.3.1 *Materials.* When specified, samples of cloth and paper shall be furnished in order to determine compliance with the applicable material requirements of this specification (see 3.1), when tested in accordance with 4.4.1.1 and 4.4.1.2. This specification shall apply in all other respects. When specified, the manufacturers shall furnish a certificate that the material submitted for test is made from the same materials, under the same or equivalent conditions, as those used in the manufacture of the product.

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4.2.3.1.1 *Size of cloth.* The cloth sample shall be not less than 36 inches in length and at least 8 inches wide.

4.2.3.1.2 *Size of paper.* The paper sample shall be not less than 36 inches square.

4.2.3.2 *End item.* Random sample tab sets contained in each box or envelope shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level L1 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one tab.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 *Visual and dimensional examination.* Samples taken as specified in 4.2.2 shall be visually examined in accordance with list of the defects shown in table VI. Any tab in the sample containing one or more visual defects shall be rejected. If the number of defective tabs in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

TABLE VI.—*List of defects (major)*

Visual examination
Tabs not type and class specified.
Color of tabs and strips, not as specified.
Color of tabs and strips not uniform within the box, or from box to box.
Sizes of tabs and strip (tab projection, tab length, skirt length, height of letters and numbers, as applicable), not as specified.
Tab marking and number of tabs per set, not as specified.
Marking of tabs, interior, and exterior containers inadequate (wrong place, wrong size, not complete, illegible, omission of special marking as applicable).
Materials missing from containers or damaged and defective, affecting serviceability.

4.4 Tests.

4.4.1 *Tests for materials.* Samples obtained in accordance with 4.2.3.1.1 and 4.2.3.1.2 shall be subjected to the following tests. Failure to pass the tests for materials shall be considered cause for rejection of the lot, as not meeting the material requirements of this specification.

4.4.1.1 *Cloth.* The samples shall be tested in accordance with the following test methods described in CCC-T-191:

Yarns per inch in wool fabric—Test Method No. 5050
Strength of cloth, tearing—Test Method No. 5132

4.4.1.2 *Paper.* The samples shall be tested in accordance with the following test methods described in UU-P-31, for applicable requirements specified in 3.1.2.1 and 3.1.2.2.

Basis weight—Test Method No. 110.
Tearing resistance—Test Method No. 170.
Thickness—Test Method No. 173.
Fiber identification and quantitative determination—Test Method No. 300.

4.4.2 *Tests for end-item.* Samples selected in accordance with 4.2.3.2, shall be subjected to the following tests. Any tab in the sample failing one or more tests shall be considered a defective tab. If the number of defective tabs exceeds the acceptance number for the sample, the lot represented by the sample shall be rejected.

4.4.2.1 *Blocking of gum.* Condition 20 tabs or strips and 20 sheets of bond paper of suitable size at 70° ± 2° F., and 80 ± 2 percent relative humidity for 24 hours. The bond paper shall conform to type III of UU-P-121. At the end of the conditioning period, stack the labels evenly, interleaved with the bond paper, apply a pressure of 4 pounds per square inch to the stack, and allow it to remain in the stated atmospheric condi-

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tion for another 24 hours. Condition the stack then, with the pressure still applied, for 24 hours, at 70° ± 5° F. and 65 ± 2 percent relative humidity. The labels shall be examined for blocking (adherence of the adhesive to the paper).

4.4.2.2 *Adhesion of gum.* The gummed surface of the skirts of 10 tabs or strips shall be moistened and applied to bond paper of the same quality specified in 4.3.2.1.1. After 2 hours of drying, it shall not be possible to remove the tabs or strips without removing the surface of the paper.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement, definitions and applications of the various levels of packaging and packing specified hereinafter shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.

5.1 **Packaging.** Tabs shall be packaged level A or C, as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.*

5.1.1.1 Type I, classes 1, 2, 3, 4 and type II tabs shall be packaged in suitable boxes or sealed, flexible, plastic envelopes. Quantity shall be one set per box or envelope and 12 unit packages per suitable carton.

5.1.1.2 Type I, class 5 strips shall be packaged in suitable boxes not exceeding 1-1/2 by 6-1/2 inches. Quantity shall be one set per box and 12 boxes per suitable carton.

5.1.1.3 Type III strips shall be packaged in suitable envelopes not exceeding 2-1/2 by 6-1/2 inches, sealed at both or one end. Envelopes sealed at one end shall have a flap on the open end of sufficient length to retain the contents until used. Quantity shall be one set per envelope and five envelopes per folding paperboard box, carton or sleeve with at least one end closed.

5.1.2 *Level C.* Tabs and strips shall be packaged in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice.

5.2 **Packing.** Tabs and strips, packaged level A or C, shall be packed level A, B, or C, as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Tabs and strips shall be packed in overseas type or class boxes conforming to any of the following specifications:

PPP-B-585, class 3 — Box, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-591—Box, Fiberboard, Wood-Cleated.
PPP-B-601—Box, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621—Box, Wood, Nailed and Lock Corner.
PPP-B-636, V3c or V3s—Box, Fiberboard, Class 2.
PPP-B-645—Box, Folding, Fiberboard, Heavy Duty.
MIL-B-10377—Box, Wood, Cleated, Veneer, Paper Overlaid.

Gross weight of wood and wood-cleated boxes shall not exceed 200-pounds, fiber boxes shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Box closures and strapping shall conform to the box specification and the appendix thereto. In lieu of steel strapping, fiber boxes may be reinforced with pressure-sensitive filament tape conforming to PPP-T-97; type IV, applied in accordance with the appendix thereto. Boxes shall be provided with case liners conforming to MIL-L-10547, sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Tabs and strips shall be packed in fiber boxes conforming to PPP-B-636, class 1. Gross weight shall not exceed the weight limitations of the box specification. Box closures shall conform to the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.* Tabs and strips shall be packed in containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carrier and safe delivery at destination.

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Shipping containers shall comply with the regulations of carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, each unit, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.*

5.3.2.1 *Interior packages.* Unit and intermediate packages, except envelopes for type III, shall be marked in accordance with manufacturer's commercial practice. Marking shall include Federal stock number, nomenclature and quantity.

5.3.2.2 *Shipping containers.* In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** The tabs covered herein are to be used on folders or record documents to facilitate the identification of file content.

6.2 **Ordering data.** Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Type and class of tabs required (1.2.1).
(*c*) Colors, sizes, and marking of tabs required (3.2.6.1, for colors; 3.2.2.2, 3.2.3.3, 3.2.4.2, and 3.2.6.2, for sizes; 3.2.3.2, for marking).
(*d*) Level of packaging and packing required (5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 **Samples.** It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material, and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

6.4 **Transportation description.** Transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Stationery, not otherwise indexed by name.
Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Stationery, not otherwise indexed.
Truckload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

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